



STEADY BURN

Forging A Stronger Purposeful Man

FIRE - FURNACE - FORGE

ALIGN Your Values With Your Actions

Introduction

A value is not something you admire.

A value is something you obey.

Most men do not lose themselves all at once. They drift. They say family matters, but give the phone more attention than the people at the table. They say health matters, but keep treating sleep, food, and training like optional extras. They say integrity matters, but avoid the truth when honesty would cost them comfort.

The damage does not show up right away.

At first, it feels small. One skipped action. One ignored standard. One excuse that sounds reasonable enough. But over time, those small choices begin to build a case against you. You start to feel the gap. You know what you say you stand for, but your life is not giving enough proof.

That gap weakens a man.

Not because he is broken.

Because he is divided.

One part of him knows the standard. Another part keeps choosing what is easier. That split creates pressure. It shows up as frustration, guilt, low trust in yourself, and a quiet sense that you are not living as cleanly as you could.

This worksheet is designed to close one gap.

Not every gap.

One.

You are not here to rebuild your whole life in one sitting. You are here to take one value you claim, inspect it honestly, and turn it into one clear action that can be lived this week.

The process is called ALIGN.

Each letter gives you one move.

A: Admit the Value L: List the Evidence I: Identify the Gap G: Give It One Rule N: Nail It This Week

Move through each step slowly. Do not write what sounds impressive. Write what is true. This worksheet only works if you stop performing and start inspecting.

Your goal is not to feel better about your values.

Your goal is to make one value visible through behavior.

A: Admit the Value

Start by choosing one core value you want to inspect.

This is the value you say matters, but you suspect your current behavior may not fully support it. Do not choose the value that makes you look good. Choose the one that creates the strongest signal.

If the word makes you pause, it may be the right one.

This section asks you to name the standard. Until the value is named, the gap stays vague. Once it is named, your behavior has something to answer to.

Do not write a long list of values here. That is a way to avoid pressure. Pick one. The power of this worksheet comes from focus.

Ask yourself:

What value do I often talk about but struggle to live?

What value would make the biggest difference if I honored it this week?

What value have I been quietly neglecting?

What value would my family, coworkers, or closest friends say needs more proof from me?

Fill out this section with one value and a short reason why it matters.

What to avoid:

- Avoid choosing a value because it sounds strong, like “excellence,” if you are not willing to inspect it honestly.
- Avoid writing several values at once, like “family, health, discipline, and faith.”
- Avoid vague words without meaning, like “success” or “better life,” unless you define them clearly.

- Avoid blaming other people for why you have not lived the value.
- Avoid writing what you think a good man should say instead of what is actually true for you.

What works:

- “Family, because I say they come first, but they often get my leftover attention.”
- “Health, because my body is showing the cost of my choices.”
- “Integrity, because I have been avoiding one honest conversation.”
- “Discipline, because I keep letting my mood decide whether I follow through.”
- “Growth, because I consume content but do not apply enough of it.”

Your worksheet answer should be clear enough that a stranger could understand the value and why it matters.

L: List the Evidence

Now you are going to list the evidence.

This is where the worksheet becomes honest.

You will make two lists.

First, write the behaviors that support this value.

Second, write the behaviors that undermine this value.

Do not judge the evidence while you write it. Do not explain it away. Do not turn this into a speech. Just put the facts on paper.

Your actions are already telling a story. This step helps you read it.

If your value is family, supporting evidence might include showing up for dinner, helping with school events, paying bills, or calling your parents each week.

Undermining evidence might include checking work email during family time, losing patience too quickly, missing important moments, or being physically present but mentally absent.

If your value is health, supporting evidence might include going to the gym twice a week, drinking water, or walking during lunch.

Undermining evidence might include sleeping five hours, eating fast food most days, skipping medical appointments, or using stress as an excuse to neglect your body.

Be specific.

Specific evidence creates useful pressure.

Vague evidence creates escape routes.

What to avoid:

- Avoid writing, “I try my best.” That is not evidence.
- Avoid writing, “I care about it.” Caring is not proof.
- Avoid only listing the good side so you can feel better.
- Avoid only listing the bad side so you can punish yourself.
- Avoid using words like “always” and “never” unless they are actually true.
- Avoid blaming your schedule, spouse, boss, kids, or stress before naming your own choices.

What works:

- “I support family by being home for dinner four nights a week.”
- “I undermine family by scrolling on my phone while my kids are talking.”
- “I support health by training Monday and Thursday.”
- “I undermine health by sleeping five hours most weeknights.”
- “I support integrity by being honest in small issues at work.”
- “I undermine integrity by avoiding the hard conversation with my brother.”

The goal is not to make yourself look good or bad.

The goal is to see clearly.

I: Identify the Gap

Now look at both lists.

The gap is the place where your stated value and your current behavior do not match.

This is the most important part of the worksheet.

Do not choose the smallest gap. Choose the one that carries the most weight. You are looking for the behavior that creates the most internal conflict.

Ask yourself:

Which behavior makes me feel least aligned with this value?

Which behavior would I be embarrassed to explain out loud?

Which behavior, if corrected, would create the biggest shift this week?

Which behavior keeps repeating even though I know better?

Your answer should name one clear gap.

Not five.

Not a full life diagnosis.

One gap.

If you choose too many, you will leave with pressure but no action. If you choose one, you can move.

What to avoid:

- Avoid writing, “I need to be better.” That is too vague.
- Avoid writing, “I need to fix everything.” That creates overwhelm.
- Avoid choosing a gap you cannot act on this week.
- Avoid making the gap about someone else’s behavior.
- Avoid turning the gap into shame, like “I am a terrible father” or “I have no discipline.”

What works:

- “I say family matters, but I keep giving work my attention after dinner.”
- “I say health matters, but I keep choosing fast food because I do not plan lunch.”
- “I say integrity matters, but I have delayed one honest conversation for three weeks.”
- “I say growth matters, but I spend my evenings watching videos instead of studying.”
- “I say discipline matters, but I keep negotiating with myself every morning.”

This step should create a clean sentence.

Use this format if needed:

“I say I value ___, but my behavior shows ___.”

That sentence is not an attack.

It is a map.

G: Give It One Rule

Now you turn the gap into a rule.

A value without a rule stays abstract. A rule gives the value a body. It tells you what to do when pressure arrives.

The rule must be simple, clear, and measurable.

You should know whether you kept it.

Do not create a rule that depends on emotion. Do not write, “Be more present,” unless you define what presence means in behavior. Do not write, “Try harder,” because trying harder cannot be tracked.

A strong rule removes negotiation.

It tells you what the aligned man does.

Examples:

If the value is family and the gap is work stealing attention after dinner, the rule could be:

“No work email from 6:30 p.m. to 8:30 p.m.”

If the value is health and the gap is fast food at lunch, the rule could be:

“Pack lunch Monday through Thursday.”

If the value is growth and the gap is screen time at night, the rule could be:

“Read 20 pages before opening YouTube.”

If the value is integrity and the gap is avoiding the truth, the rule could be:

“Have the conversation by Friday at 5 p.m.”

What to avoid:

- Avoid rules that are too broad, like “Be healthier.”
- Avoid rules that are too extreme, like “Never eat anything bad again.”
- Avoid rules that require a perfect week to count.
- Avoid rules that depend on other people changing.
- Avoid rules that sound strong but are not realistic for your actual life.

What works:

- “Phone stays in another room during family dinner.”
- “Lights out by 10:30 p.m. on work nights.”
- “Gym Monday, Wednesday, and Friday at 6 a.m.”
- “Send the honest message today before noon.”
- “Spend 30 minutes Saturday morning with my child, no phone.”
- “Read 10 pages before entertainment each night.”

A useful rule should pass three tests:

Can I do it this week?

Can I measure it?

Does it directly support the value?

If the answer is yes, write it down.

N: Nail It This Week

Now the worksheet moves from insight to proof.

You have named the value.

You have listed the evidence.

You have found the gap.

You have written the rule.

Now you must live it.

This final step is where most men lose the lesson. They feel clear, close the worksheet, and change nothing. That is how insight becomes another form of delay.

Do not let that happen.

Write exactly when, where, and how you will act this week.

If your rule is about dinner, write which nights it applies.

If your rule is about exercise, write the days and times.

If your rule is about a conversation, write the deadline.

If your rule is about sleep, write the cutoff time.

Pressure will show up. Expect it. You will get tired. Work will ask for more. Your old habit will feel easier. Your mood will argue. That moment is the point of the assignment.

You are not proving the value when it is easy.

You are proving it when something else competes for your obedience.

What to avoid:

- Avoid writing, "I'll start soon."
- Avoid waiting for Monday if you can take action today.
- Avoid making this dependent on motivation.
- Avoid quitting the whole rule because you missed one attempt.
- Avoid treating the worksheet as the win. The action is the win.

What works:

- "Tonight at dinner, my phone stays in the bedroom."
- "Tomorrow morning at 6:00, I train before checking messages."
- "By Friday at noon, I will call my brother and have the honest conversation."
- "Sunday at 4:00, I will prep three lunches for the week."
- "Each night this week, I read 10 pages before any show or scrolling."

At the end of the week, return to this section and record what happened.

Do not only record whether you succeeded.

Record what the action proved.

Ask:

What changed when I acted in alignment?

What resistance showed up?

What did I learn about my current identity?

What rule needs to stay in place next week?

The goal is not to complete a worksheet.

The goal is to create evidence.

When you act in alignment, even once, you give yourself proof that your values can become structure.

When you repeat that proof, it becomes trust.

When trust compounds, it becomes identity.

Closing Charge

Do not hide behind good intentions.

Your life is already showing what you truly honor.

This worksheet gives you a chance to correct one part of the record.

Choose one value.

Find one gap.

Write one rule.

Live it this week.

Your values do not need more admiration.

They need proof.